

### IDC predicts 3D printing to be mainstream in Asia within three years

The 3D printing industry was relatively quiet in 2016. A major reason for this is that despite efficiency improvements additive manufacturing is bringing to commercial markets, the consumer-facing 3D printing industry did not live up to the hype. IDC, a global market intelligence firm, is now predicting that by 2018, 3D printing will be a mainstream technology in Asia. It is also predicting market consolidation, however, with 30 per cent fewer companies.

China will remain the main 3D printing market in the region. The country's cheaper 3D printers for consumer and education markets have caused trouble

for larger American competitors.

As the 3D printing industry is expanding, it has seen growth in mergers and acquisitions. IDC expects this activity to increase in the future, resulting in 30 per cent fewer 3D printing companies by 2018. This is a sign of a maturing industry.

IDC also makes the prediction that 3D printing will play a pivotal role in making customised exoskeletons. Some limited trials have already seen these kinds of products put to medical use. The exoskeletons can be used to help paraplegics walk, among other uses. IDC expects the medical sector to have the strongest growth in the industry.

### Idea, Vodafone India merge to create India's largest telco

Kumar Mangalam Birla owned Idea Cellular has said that its Board has approved of a merger with Vodafone India and its wholly-owned subsidiary Vodafone India Mobile Services, which will create India's largest mobile phone company with about 400 million customers, 35 per cent customer market share and 41 per cent revenue market share. Vodafone India's business, barring its investments in Indus Towers, will vest in the new entity, which will be renamed at a later stage.

Vodafone will own 45.1 per cent in the combined entity after transferring

4.9 per cent to the promoters of Idea Cellular for ₹ 38.74 billion in cash post the merger. Kumar Mangalam Birla and other promoters of Idea Group will hold 26 per cent and the rest will be owned by the public.

Before completion of the transaction, Vodafone and Idea intend to sell their standalone tower assets and Idea's 11.15 per cent stake in Indus Towers to reduce leverage in the combined company. Vodafone will also explore strategic options for its 42 per cent stake in Indus Towers—potential options include either a partial or a full disposal.

### TPDDL launches energy-efficient LED lights, fans

Electricity distribution company Tata Power-DDL (TPDDL) has launched energy-efficient LED lighting and ceiling

fans in association with Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (under UJALA scheme) for its customers. According

### On The Move

#### Sudhin Mathur appointed MD, Motorola India

Sudhin Mathur has been named managing director of Motorola Mobility India, and has been inducted as a full-time director on the company's Board. He will also continue to serve in the role of executive director for Lenovo MBG India. Mathur replaces Amit Boni, who was serving as general manager for Motorola India.

#### TCS appoints Ramakrishnan as CFO

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has appointed V. Ramakrishnan as chief financial officer. He takes over from Rajesh Gopinathan, who has been appointed as chief executive officer and managing director. Ramakrishnan joined TCS in 1999 and served as finance head of TCS North America for seven years. Recently, he was responsible for financial controllership of TCS subsidiaries and various merger and acquisitions integration initiatives.

#### Manu Kumar Jain is vice president at Xiaomi

Manu Kumar Jain, who was leading Xiaomi's India operations until last month, has been promoted to the post of vice president of Xiaomi. The development came after Hugo Barra, Xiaomi's global vice president, announced his decision to leave the company.

#### Snapdeal's VP engineering quits

Amitava Ghosh, vice president - engineering at Snapdeal, is on his way out. Ghosh, a former tech lead at taxi aggregator TaxiForSure, joined Snapdeal in August 2015. He was based out of the retailer's Bengaluru office.